PARISHRAM 2.0

CLASS 12TH 2026

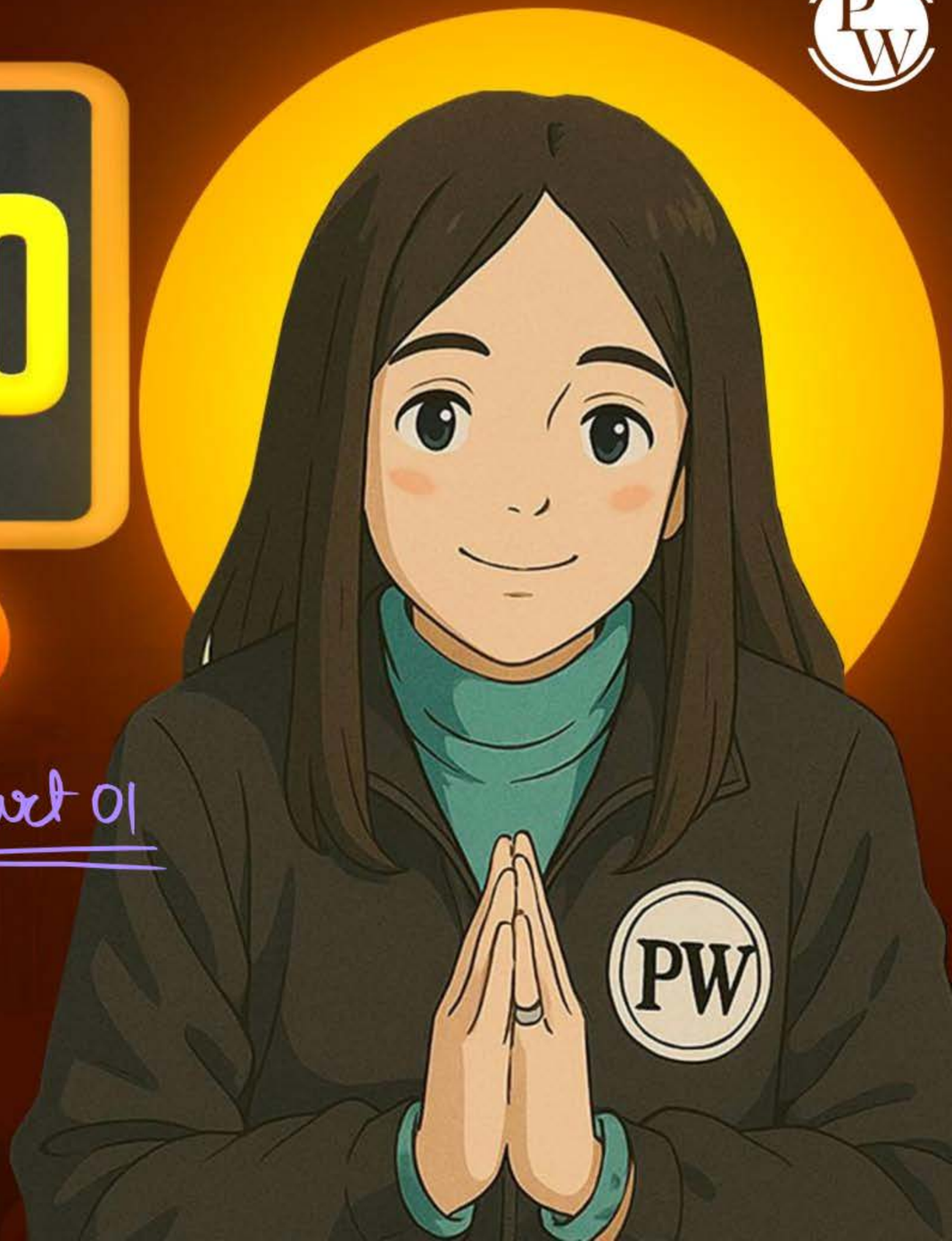
Flamingo-

Lost Spring

Part 01

ENGLISH LECTURE 03

BY-NIHARIKA MA'AM



TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1

Lost Spring

खोया

वसंत

Flowers Bloom
happy and
enjoyable

Childhood

growing age
tension free
enjoyable

Labour

earn money


WELCOME TO OUR TEAM
English
Rocket
Raccoon
Pinki
Panda
YOU ARE GOING TO LOVE
IT HERE!


Welcome
Can’t wait to see you
SHINE
in my Class!

Topic : Lost Spring

'Sometimes I find a Rupee in the garbage'

"Why do you do this?" I ask Saheb whom I encounter every morning scrounging for gold in the garbage dumps of my neighbourhood. Saheb left his home long ago. Set amidst the green fields of Dhaka, his home is not even a distant memory. There were many storms that swept away their fields and homes, his mother tells him. That's why they left, looking for gold in the big city where he now lives.

"I have nothing else to do," he mutters, looking away.

Writer - Anees Jung



Saheb - e - Alam

Seemapuri

Rag picker - garbage picker

Topic : Lost Spring

"Go to school," I say glibly, realising immediately how hollow the advice must sound.

"There is no school in my neighbourhood. When they build one, I will go."

"If I start a school, will you come?" I ask, half-joking. "Yes," he says, smiling broadly. A few days later I see him running up to me. "Is your school ready?"

"It takes longer to build a school," I say, embarrassed at having made a promise that was not meant. But promises like mine abound in every corner of his bleak world.



Topic : Lost Spring



After months of knowing him, I ask him his name. "Saheb-e-Alam," he announces. He does not know what it means.

If he knew its meaning — lord of the universe — he would have a hard time believing it.

Unaware of what his name represents, he roams the streets with his friends, an army of barefoot boys who appear like the morning birds and disappear at noon.

Over the months, I have come to recognise each of them.

Topic : Lost Spring

"Why aren't you wearing chappals?" I ask one. "My mother did not bring them down from the shelf," he answers simply.

"Even if she did he will throw them off," adds another who is wearing shoes that do not match.

When I comment on it, he shuffles his feet and says nothing. "I want shoes," says a third boy who has never owned a pair all his life.

Travelling across the country I have seen children walking barefoot, in cities, on village roads.



Topic : Lost Spring

It is not lack of money but a tradition to stay barefoot, is one explanation. I wonder if this is only an excuse to explain away a perpetual state of poverty.

I remember a story a man from Udipti once told me. As a young boy he would go to school past an old temple, where his father was a priest. He would stop briefly at the temple and pray for a pair of shoes. Thirty years later I visited his town and the temple, which was now drowned in an air of desolation. In the backyard, where lived the new priest, there were red and white plastic chairs.



→ Flashback

Topic : Lost Spring

A young boy dressed in a grey uniform, wearing socks and shoes, arrived panting and threw his school bag on a folding bed. short of breath

Looking at the boy, I remembered the prayer another boy had made to the goddess when he had finally got a pair of shoes, "Let me never lose them." – grateful

The goddess had granted his prayer. Young boys like the son of the priest now wore shoes.

But many others like the ragpickers in my neighbourhood remain shoeless.



Old boy ↓ Thankful

New boy ↓ ungrateful

Topic : Lost Spring

My acquaintance with the barefoot ragpickers leads me to Seemapuri, a place on the periphery of Delhi yet miles away from it, metaphorically. Those who live here are squatters who came from Bangladesh back in 1971. Saheb's family is among them. Seemapuri was then a wilderness. It still is, but it is no longer empty. In structures of mud, with roofs of tin and tarpaulin, devoid of sewage, drainage or running water, live 10,000 ragpickers.



Topic : Lost Spring

They have lived here for more than thirty years without an identity, without permits but with ration cards that get their names on voters' lists and enable them to buy grain. Food is more important for survival than an identity.



"If at the end of the day we can feed our families and go to bed without an aching stomach, we would rather live here than in the fields that gave us no grain," say a group of women in tattered saris when I ask them why they left their beautiful land of green fields and rivers.



Topic : Lost Spring

Wherever they find food, they pitch their tents that become transit homes. Children grow up in them, becoming partners in survival. And survival in Seemapuri means rag-picking. Through the years, it has acquired the proportions of a fine art. Garbage to them is gold. It is their daily bread, a roof over their heads, even if it is a leaking roof. But for a child it is even more.

"I sometimes find a rupee, even a ten-rupee note," Saheb says, his eyes lighting up.



Topic : Lost Spring

When you can find a silver coin in a heap of garbage, you don't stop scrounging, for there is hope of finding more. It seems that for children, garbage has a meaning different from what it means to their parents.

For the children it is wrapped in wonder, for the elders it is a means of survival.

One winter morning I see Saheb standing by the fenced gate of the neighbourhood club, watching two young men dressed in white, playing tennis. "I like the game," he hums, content to watch it standing behind the fence.



Topic : Lost Spring

"I go inside when no one is around," he admits.
"The gatekeeper lets me use the swing." – sympathetic
Saheb too is wearing tennis shoes that look strange over his dis coloured (dull) shirt and shorts. "Someone gave them to me," he says in the manner of an explanation. The fact that they are discarded (given / rejected) shoes of some rich boy, who perhaps refused to wear them because of a hole in one of them, does not bother him. For one who has walked barefoot, even shoes with a hole is a dream come true.

(affect)



explain
"Someone's garbage is another gold"

Topic : Lost Spring

But the game he is watching so intently is out of his reach. This morning, Saheb is on his way to the milk booth. In his hand is a steel canister. "I now work in a tea stall down the road," he says, pointing in the distance. "I am paid 800 rupees and all my meals." Does he like the job? I ask.

His face, I see, has lost the carefree look. The steel canister seems heavier than the plastic bag he would carry so lightly over his shoulder. The bag was his. The canister belongs to the man who owns the tea shop. Saheb is no longer his own master!





QUESTION

#Q. What forces the children to live a life of exploitation?

1. Greed
2. Extreme Poverty
3. Peers
4. Parents



QUESTION

#Q. According to the author what was garbage for the parents?

1. Means of entertainment
2. Means of joy
3. Means of sorrow
4. Means of survival ✓



QUESTION

#Q. According to the author what was garbage for the children ?

1. Means of entertainment
2. Means of timepass
3. Means of playing
4. A wonder ✓



QUESTION

#Q. Who was Saheb?

1. A shopkeeper
2. A servant
3. A ragpicker
4. All



QUESTION

#Q. What was Saheb looking for?

1. Eggs
2. Gold
3. Coins
4. Toys



QUESTION

#Q. Is Saheb happy working at the tea stall?

1. Yes
2. Yes, he earns money
3. No earning
4. No, earning but no freedom ✓



QUESTION

#Q. Why did Saheb -e- Alam not go to school?

1. Not interested
2. Had no money to pay fees
3. Wanted to go for movie
4. Wanted to earn money



QUESTION

#Q. What is the meaning of Saheb -e- Alam?

1. Owner
2. Rich man
3. Poor man
4. Lord of the Universe



QUESTION

#Q. Where was Saheb employed?

1. At a tea stall in Seemapuri
2. At a saree shop
3. At a jewellery shop
4. At a sweet shop



QUESTION

#Q. Why is the author calling garbage as ‘gold’ in the story?

1. Because of jewels in it
2. Because of gems in it
3. Because of gold in it
4. Because of its encashment value



QUESTION

#Q. What do the boys appear like to the author in the story?

1. Morning crows
2. Evening crows
3. Morning birds
4. Evening Birds



QUESTION

#Q. Did Mukesh's parents know that it is illegal for children to work in bangle making?

1. No
2. Yes
3. Not mentioned
4. None of these.



QUESTION

#Q. What are the biggest dangers of working in a glass furnace?

1. Addiction of money at young age
2. There is a fear of losing eye brightness in early age
3. Accompaniment is bad
4. Drugs addiction



QUESTION

#Q. What is a shack?

1. Tarpaulin
2. Hut
3. Broken house
4. None of the above



QUESTION

#Q. What was Mukesh's father source of livelihood before bangle making?

1. Tailoring
2. Brokerage
3. Farming
4. Car mechanic



QUESTION

#Q. Why Mukesh's father failed to build a pucca house despite being a hard worker?

1. His expenses were more than income
2. He had a big family to feed
3. He had lot of liabilities
4. He had put all the money in the education and upbringing of the children



QUESTION

#Q. What is Saheb looking for in the garbage dumps? Where is he and where has he come from?

Ans. Saheb is looking for gold (valuable) in the garbage dumps. He is in the neighbourhood of the author. Saheb has come from Bangladesh. He Came with his mother in 1971. His house was set amidst the green fields of Dhaka. Storms swept away their fields and homes. So, they left the country

QUESTION

#Q. Is Saheb happy working at the tea-stall? Explain.

Ans. No, Saheb is not happy working at the tea-stall. He is no longer his own master. His face has lost the carefree look. The steel canister seems heavier than the plastic bag he would carry so lightly over his shoulder. The bag was his. The canister belongs to the man who own s the tea-shop.

terms of responsibility

QUESTION

#Q. How does the author focus on the 'perpetual state of poverty' of the children not wearing footwear?

Ans. The author notices that most of the young children engaged in rag picking are not wearing footwear. Some of them do not have chappals. Others want to wear shoes. Some say it is tradition to stay barefoot. To the author it seems lack of money. Poverty forces them to walk without footwear.

QUESTION

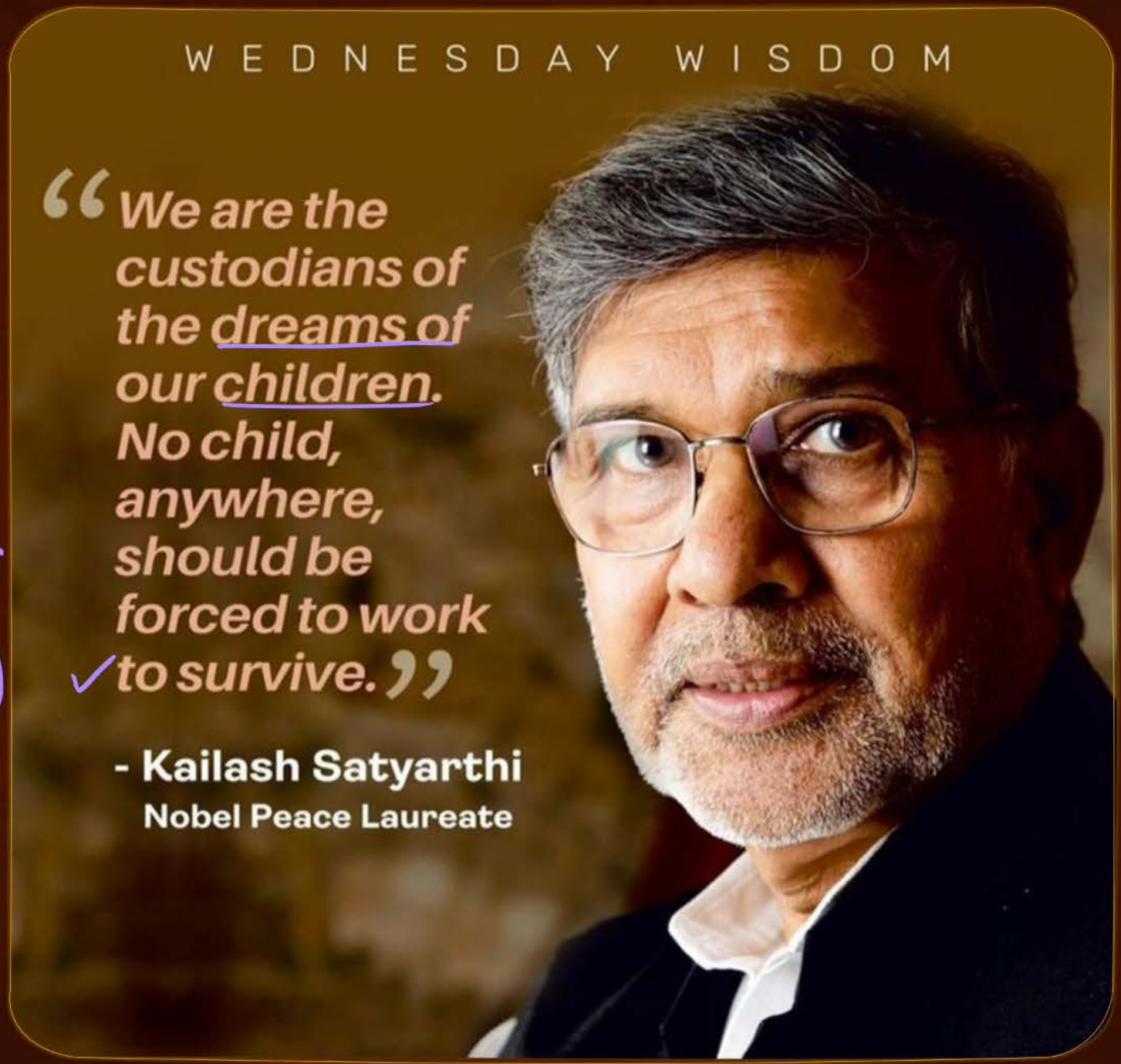
#Q. Explain: "For children, garbage has a meaning different from what it means to their parents."

Ans. Small children scrounge heaps of garbage. They expect to get some coin, note or valuable thing in it. Sometimes they find a rupee or even a ten rupee note. This gives the hope of finding more. They search it excitedly, For children, garbage is wrapped in wonder. For the elders it is a means of survival. Thus, garbage has two different meanings.

QUESTION

#Q. How has "a dream come true" for Saheb but what is "out of his reach?"

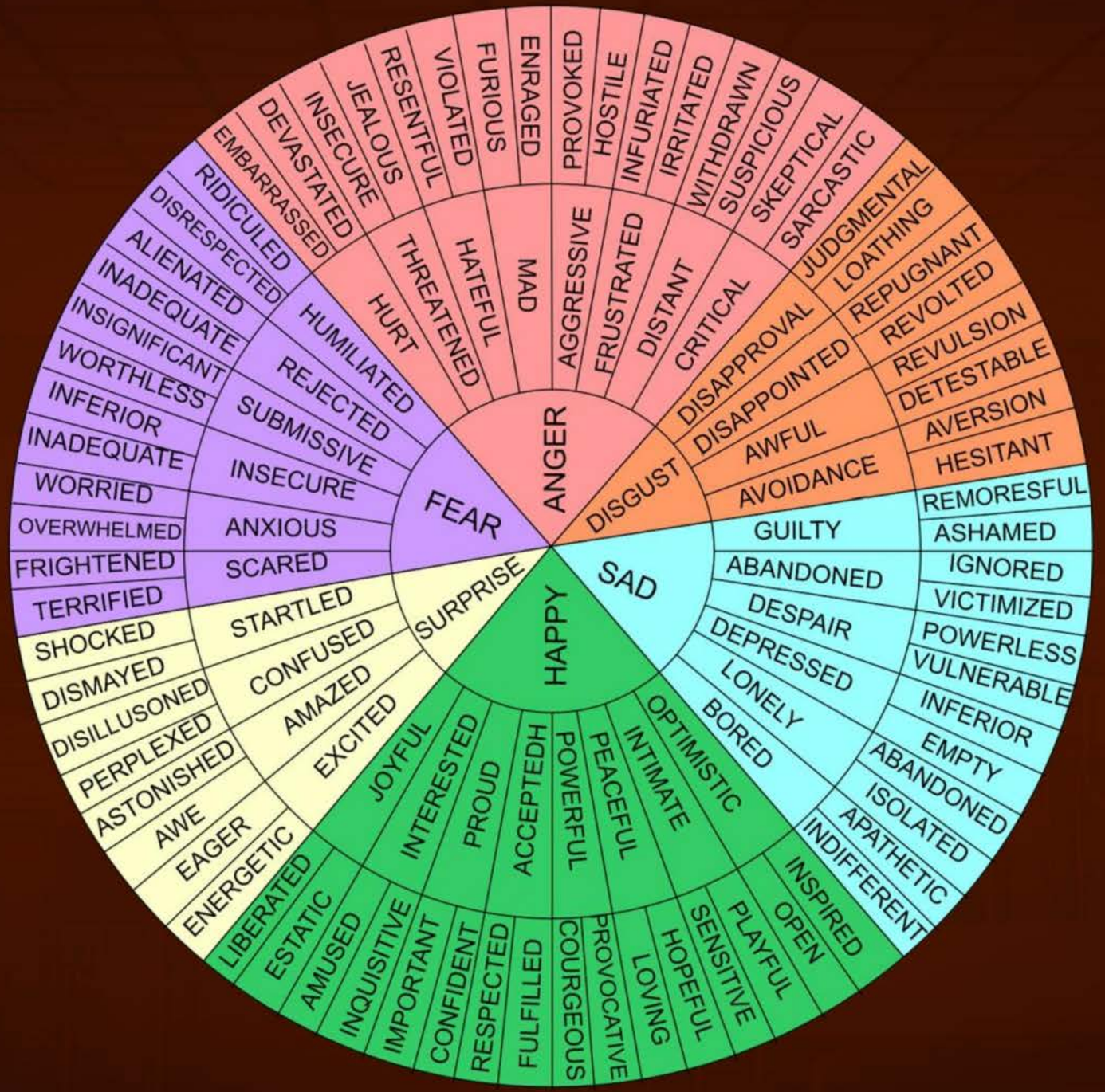
Ans. Saheb is wearing discarded tennis shoes. One of them has a hole. Saheb does not bother about the hole. For one who has walked barefoot, even shoes with a hole is a dream come true. But tennis, the game he is watching so intently, is out of his reach.



Used in your answers

QOTD


Part 2
notes - combined
next class
PPT.
BYE, BYE.


FEAR
HURT
HUMILIATED
RIDICULED
EMBARRASSED
REJECTED
DISRESPECTED
SUBMISSIVE
ALIENATED
INSECURE
INADEQUATE
ANXIOUS
INSIGNIFICANT
SCARED
WORTHLESS
INFERIOR
INADEQUATE
WORRIED
OVERWHELMED
FRIGHTENED
TERRIFIED
THREATENED
HATEFUL
DEVASTATED
INSECURE
JEALOUS
RESENTFUL
VIOLATED
FURIOUS
ENRAGED
MAD
PROVOKED
AGGRESSIVE
HOSTILE
FRUSTRATED
INFURIATED
DISTANT
IRRITATED
CRITICAL
WITHDRAWN
SUSPICIOUS
SKEPTICAL
SARCASTIC
ANGER
DISGUST
JUDGMENTAL
DISAPPROVAL
LOATHING
DISAPPOINTED
REPUGNANT
AWFUL
REVOLTED
AVOIDANCE
REVULSION
DETESTABLE
AVERSION
HESITANT
SURPRISE
STARTLED
SHOCKED
DISMAYED
CONFUSED
DISILLUSONED
PERPLEXED
AMAZED
ASTONISHED
AWE
EXCITED
EAGER
ENERGETIC
SAD
GUILTY
REMORESFUL
ASHAMED
ABANDONED
IGNORED
DESPAIR
VICTIMIZED
DEPRESSED
POWERLESS
LONELY
VULNERABLE
BORED
INFERIOR
EMPTY
ABANDONED
ISOLATED
APATHETIC
INDIFFERENT
HAPPY
JOYFUL
OPTIMISTIC
INTERESTED
INTIMATE
PROUD
PEACEFUL
ACCEPTEDH
POWERFUL
LIBERATED
INSPIRED
ESTATIC
OPEN
AMUSED
PLAYFUL
INQUISITIVE
SENSITIVE
IMPORTANT
HOPEFUL
CONFIDENT
LOVING
RESPECTED
PROVOCATIVE
FULFILLED
COURGEOUS

THANK YOU